

# Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of hands-on legal practice support at BCLP, where I worked with matter management systems, assisted with matter opening and closure, cost comparisons and deadline tracking across several concurrent files. Further experience managing case records and documentation at Citizens Advice and conducting legal and compliance work at Adobe. Looking to move into legal cashiering and build specialist expertise in legal accounts and financial administration within a law firm environment.

## EDUCATION

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### Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

### Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

### International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

## EXPERIENCE

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### Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

#### Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration matter
- Assisted with matter administration including document organisation, coordinating translations with an external supplier and liaising with the client on required materials
- Tracked outstanding actions and coordinated documents in the lead-up to a significant filing deadline, becoming the primary junior supporting the team at that stage
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

### Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

#### Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Assisted with matter opening and closure, hearing arrangements, court filings and deadline tracking
- Conducted cost comparisons and maintained matter records via iManage across several concurrent files
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents with competing deadlines, maintaining accuracy throughout
- Prepared electronic bundles and supported hearing preparation across multiple active matters

### Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

#### Legal Adviser

- Manages matters end to end: takes client instructions, drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and maintains confidential case records to deadline

- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria across welfare, housing and debt matters; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Maintains accurate, organised file records across a volume of concurrent matters with tight deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements, translating complex rules into clear practical guidance

#### **Q-Legal · London**

**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025**

##### **Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the matter deadline; maintained accurate file records throughout
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations and translated statutory requirements into clear, practical advice

#### **Adobe · London**

**June 2022 – Aug 2022**

##### **Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and flagged provisions requiring legal input
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

## **SKILLS**

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**Languages:** Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

**Technical skills:** iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems; legal and commercial research; concise report writing

**Case and evidence management:** Matter opening and closure; deadline tracking; cost comparisons; case-file organisation; hearing bundles; procedural histories; evidence review